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UNITED STATES CONSULATE GENERAL
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Mr. Isherwood

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No 141

United States Consulate
Amoy July 23d 1874

Wm I I Anderson Consul
To the Department of State
Washington D.C.

Subject
Absence from Post.

Contents
Account of a visit to Viceroy of
Fuh Kien & Chekiang provinces

No. 41. United States Consulate,
Amoy, July 23rd 1874

Hon J. C. B. Davis
Assistant Secretary of State.
Washington D. C.

Sir,

I have the honor to report an absence from my consular district of seven days, beginning with the 13th instant.

Not having yet called upon the provincial authorities and having been offered by Admiral Li (Chinese) the use of a ship for that purpose I concluded a favorable time and opportunity for doing so had arrived, and on the 12th instant at 12 O'Clock we sailed for Foochowfoo, on board His Imperial Majesty's S. S. Nao.

This vessel is of modern construction and equipment, carrying seven guns, and is commanded, and wholly officered and manned by Chinese. She was constructed at the Foochow arsenal under foreign supervision along with a number of others.

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crew are under most perfect discipline and the ship herself is a model of neatness and order, while her commander and officers are all intelligent young gentlemen who have been instructed in their professional by foreigners in charge of the educational department at the arsenal. The commands on board are all given and the log kept, in the English language. I had a most agreable passage and arrived at Pagodah anchorage, 12 miles below Foochow at noon on Monday and finished the journey in a sampan. At Foochow I accepted the hospitality of Mr Consul De Lano. This gentleman has been mainly instrumental in securing the introduction and construction of the telegraph line to Foochow from Pagodah Anchorage

Although I had gone to Foochow with no other object than to see His Excellency Viceroy Lê and talk over matters of interest to us both, I was aware of his custom of requiring Consuls to enter his Yamen through the small or side gate and path, reserving

the

greater honor of the large or middle gate and path for officers of the highest rank, and I determined before hand not to submit to it, even though the resolution might involve my return to Oman without an interview. Last winter the foreign Consuls had united in an attempt to enter through the main gate, but had failed. If some circumstances seemed to favor success, many others made it appear doubtful. The plan which seemed to me most promising was to pretend entire ignorance of the custom and controversy regarding the gate and ride to the Yamen as though I was certain to be received with the highest honors and if requested to enter through the side gate, express my surprise and embarrassment at being subjected to a more local regulation well enough among themselves perhaps, but which applied to me became a condition at once so humiliating that I could not submit to it without losing my own self respect. And

declini

to enter on equal terms with servants and coolies. H. Excy named 11 AM. on Tuesday for my reception, and requesting my interpreter Lin Kein to precede me an hour. I instructed him to be in waiting at the main gate at the appointed hour and assist me in carrying out my programme.

But I do not think any man ever accomplished anything to his entire satisfaction who depended to any extent upon a Chinaman for help. Lin Kein no sooner arrived at Viceroy's Yamen than he allowed himself to be drawn into a conversation about the middle gate, asked H. E. if he would not open the main gate for me which under the circumstances was of course refused, and agreed to what he considered a great concession on the Viceroy's part, namely, a proposition from the latter to meet me at the rooms of the "Committee of Trade", and thus avoid offence to me, or his own pet custom; and not until I had been carried into the presence of H. E. Li and a hundred other Provincial dignitaries without passing through either the middle or side gate was I aware that I had been defeated or how it was done.

I had a pleasant interview of an hour and a half, mainly on the subject of the Japanese in Formosa and the Americans connected with that expedition. His Ex: denied that the Imperial Commissioner had agreed to pay the Japanese 1,200,000 or any sum of money whatever, but admitted that if the Japs: were thus to be rewarded it would be wrong to punish the Americans concerned; and requested me to withhold any order of arrest until I should hear from him again. He acknowledged that some of the officers of the Chinese Government had disclaimed jurisdiction over that part of the island of Formosa inhabited by the savages but said such disclaimer was without authority from the

Government and therefore not binding. No
sporte of the telegraph which has
been constructed from Nagodah Anchorage
to Torchow and the prospects for its
further introduction into China. A
contract for a land wire from Saowin-
foo in Central Formosa to Tamsuy
thence a cable to the mainland across
the Channel, and thence a land wire
to Torchow has been entered into with
the "G. N. T. Co" of Denmark. The
Company are to build the line for the
Govt of China.

It shall not hope for a line
from Torchow to Amoy connecting
with the mainline from Shanghai.
So much for the invasion of Formosa.

The Chinese authorities are en-
deavouring to effect a loan of one
ten million of dollars from foreign capi-
talists, and are otherwise industriously
making preparations for war.

No further news has been received
of operations in Formosa since my last despatch

I have the honor to be Sir,
Your obedt Servant
J. J. Henderson
U. S. Consul.

Dept. has communicated with Mr. Durand and awaits information & [illegible] action or expression of opinion

No 42 United States Consulate
Amoy August 10th 1894

Mr J. J. Henderson Consul
To the Dept of State.
Washington D.C.

Subject
Arrest of Charles W. LeGendre

Contents.
Press copy of dispatch no 10.
to the Legation at Peking

DEPARTMENT OF STATE RECEIVED OCT 12 1894